



Microsoft is dreaming big, and aiming to reach a billion devices over the next 2-3 years. Cross-platform bridges are one of their efforts to enable that.

A Consolidated and Enriched Store

Gone are the platform-specific stores, with Windows 10 there is a single store for all platforms running Windows, from the Raspberry Pi to the Xbox. The same store now also offers other kinds of media such as music, and videos. For developers this also means there is now a single place to submit apps to, and the possibility of submitting a single package that can run on all platforms. The Windows store is also no longer restricted in the way it was in Windows 8. It can now support traditional Win32 applications through the compatibility layer mentioned above.

To keep users secure, apps installed from the Windows store, are sandboxed from each other and can only talk to each other through APIs designed for the purpose. One app cannot interact with another apps' settings or private data, and in fact gets its own private virtual registry. This makes it harder for malware to do anything too damaging while also making it possible to quickly and consistently uninstall apps in a way that gets rid of all their data.

The features of this unified app store have also been enhanced with the ability to offer apps on a subscription model, and to have per-market pricing. The platform is now smart enough to share libraries between different applications if they use the same version, thus reducing disk space and download sizes.

There are also interesting implications of the new constantly updating model of Windows. New updates to Windows 10 can bring new platform